
Eric Whitacre

BORN 1970, AMERICAN

Whitacre has achieved huge popular success, particularly with choral compositions, which his admirers find serene and uplifting. His early musical education was patchy, but he discovered a love of choral singing when he participated in a student performance of Mozart's Requiem and subsequently trained at the Juilliard School, New York. Since the late 1990s, he has lived mainly in Los Angeles. Whitacre's flair as a public speaker has enhanced his wide appeal, especially among young people. His work is much performed by amateur as well as professional singers, and in 2009 he launched Online Choir, in which people all over the world post online videos of themselves singing his work, which are synchronized into a composite performance.

KEY WORKS: Water Night, 1995; Sleep, 2000; Lux Aurumque (Light and Gold), 2000; Paradise Lost: Shadows and Wings, 2003; The River Cam, 2011